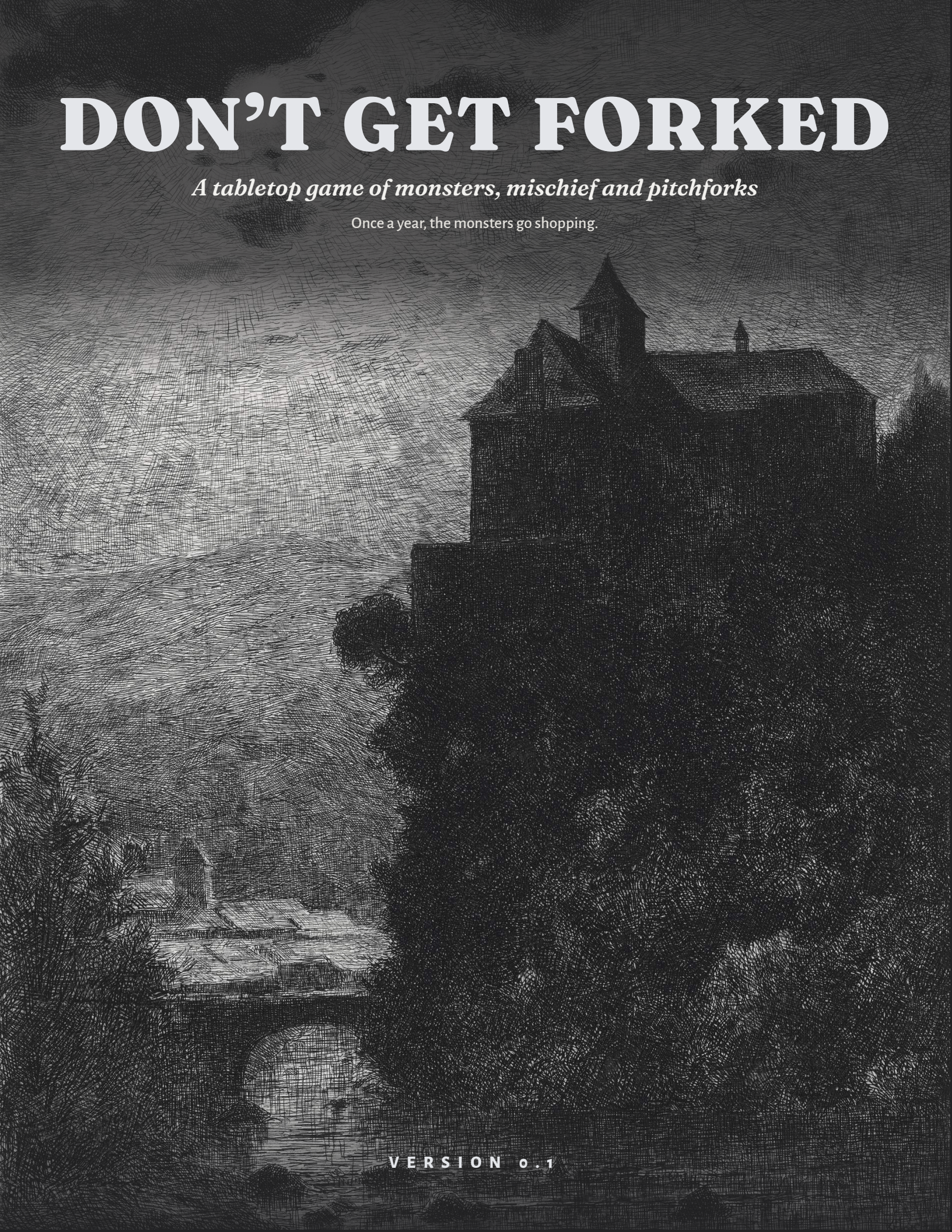


# DON'T GET FORKED

*A tabletop game of monsters, mischief and pitchforks*

Once a year, the monsters go shopping.



VERSION 0.1



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*A tabletop game of monsters, mischief and pitchforks*

VERSION 0.1

## GAME DESIGN & WRITING

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PART ONE

# Playing the Game

*The Entities, the dice, the raid, Suspicion, the chase and how  
the year went: everything the players need at the table.*





## CHAPTER 1

# The Game

**YOU PLAY CLASSIC MONSTERS WHO SHARE A CASTLE IN** the woods. Once a year, on Lantern Night, the town's festival, when everyone is in costume, you go down to steal what the castle needs. Get the shopping list home before dawn — and if the job goes wrong, outrun the mob before it corners you with pitchforks.

## What a Session Is

Each **raid** is on a town you have never seen before. It is always the year's first stock-up: nothing from earlier raids carries over unless your group uses the optional campaign rules (Chapter 7). A raid runs **1–2 hours**, so an evening often fits two.

## Who Plays

**3–5 players** each play one of the eight **Entities**. One more person is the **Storyteller**, who runs the town, its villagers and the mob. The tone is horror-comedy for about 12 and up: real stakes, dark jokes, nothing gory.

## What You Need

- A set of polyhedral dice for each player: d4, d6, d8, d10 and d12, plus a second d6 (the Mask) and a second d10 (the Monster); and a d20 for the Storyteller (a d6 halved, rounding up, serves as the d3).
- An Entity Sheet for each player (copy the one at the back of the book), and something to track Suspicion, Turns and the Lead.
- A town to raid: a premade one (Chapter 9), a map, or one rolled on the random tables (Chapter 8).

### THE RAID AT A GLANCE

- **Roll the shopping list:** one or two essentials, the rest extras.
- **Visit the town's locations** before dawn, getting past their obstacles and taking the loot.
- **Choose on every roll:** hide behind your Mask, or let the Monster out.
- **Watch Suspicion:** at the Limit, the whole town hunts you.
- **Get out of town** with the goods — or run for it, and don't get forked.







## CHAPTER 2

# The Entities

**E**IGHT ENTITIES SHARE THE CASTLE: DRACULA, Frankenstein's Creature, the Mummy, the Werewolf, the Invisible Man, a Ghost, a Witch, and Jekyll & Hyde. Each player picks one. No two players in a party play the same Entity.

## Five Traits

Every Entity has five **traits**:

| TRAIT         | FOR                                    |
|---------------|----------------------------------------|
| <b>Brawn</b>  | Force, lifting, breaking, fighting     |
| <b>Nimble</b> | Climbing, running, slipping free       |
| <b>Sly</b>    | Sneaking, hiding, stealing             |
| <b>Charm</b>  | Talking, bluffing, passing as human    |
| <b>Wits</b>   | Noticing, knowing, figuring things out |

Each trait is rated as a die. **Every Entity has one each of d12, d10, d8, d6 and d4**, placed differently: what one Entity does with a d12, another fumbles with a d4. Jekyll & Hyde has two forms on one sheet, each with its own arrangement of the same five dice.

## The Mask and the Monster

Every roll adds a second die to the trait die. You choose which: the **Mask d6**, passing as human, or the **Monster d10**, letting the monster out. The Monster is stronger, but it risks Suspicion (Chapter 3). Every Entity has the same pair.

## What Every Entity Has

- **Its dice arrangement.**
- **A signature ability**, and a second ability chosen as its **Gift**.
- **A Weakness**: something the town can use against it.
- **A Tell**: how it gives itself away.

## Three Picks

Each Entity is premade, with three picks. Every pick has a marked default, so a new player can skip the choices; to pick at random, roll a d6: 1–2 the first option, 3–4 the second, 5–6 the third (for the Castle Duty, roll on its table, rerolling one already taken).

- **Gift**: one of three versions of the Entity's second ability.
- **Perk**: one of three edges, always on and free; each bends one rule in one situation.
- **Castle Duty**: one of the castle's household jobs, shared by all the Entities, each with a small edge tied to the shopping list (hear it before you pick). No two Entities in a party take the same Duty.

## Charges

Every Entity has **3 charges**. One charge pays for one use of an ability. Charges refill once a year, at the castle; any you don't spend on a raid are lost, so spend them.

### ABILITIES NEVER PASS AUTOMATICALLY

A signature or a Gift costs a charge each time you use it and does one of four things: a bigger trait die, another trait, the Monster rolled safely, or an approach of your own (the Draught changes form instead). Each still needs a roll (Chapter 3).

## Castle Duties

Every Entity keeps one job at the castle and shops for one kind of item. **At a location whose list item is your Duty's kind, your trait die is one size larger on your own rolls there** (the furniture's obstacle included; not in a chase); it counts as that roll's one raise (Chapter 3). Each Entity's entry gives its default Duty; if two defaults clash in a party, the player who chose later picks another or rolls a d6, rerolling any Duty already taken.

| D6 | DUTY             | SHOPS FOR               | WHERE IN TOWN                                     | AT THE CASTLE                                                  |
|----|------------------|-------------------------|---------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1  | <b>Cook</b>      | food and drink          | the baker, the butcher, the tavern cellar         | Keeps the castle fed and knows every kitchen door              |
| 2  | <b>Gardener</b>  | plants and seeds        | the market garden, the florist, the seed merchant | Knows what grows where, and what's poisonous                   |
| 3  | <b>Librarian</b> | books and paper         | the bookseller, the printer, the schoolhouse      | Reads the town's notices and signs                             |
| 4  | <b>Butler</b>    | silver, china and linen | the silversmith, the china shop, the laundry      | Knows how fine houses run, and where they keep the good spoons |
| 5  | <b>Handyman</b>  | tools and hardware      | the smithy, the ironmonger, the carpenter         | Knows how locks and hinges work                                |
| 6  | <b>Tailor</b>    | cloth and costumes      | the draper, the tailor, the hatter                | Keeps everyone's disguises in one piece                        |

## The Eight

The entries use terms from Chapters 3–6; a new player can take the defaults and come back to them.

### Dracula



IN COSTUME



REVEALED

Brawn **d8** · Nimble **d10** · Sly **d6** · Charm **d12** · Wits **d4**

**Signature: Mesmerise** 1 CHARGE

At a watched obstacle that doesn't list Charm, roll Charm at 2 lower Difficulty. Only you get past, except at the way out and the lock-up (Chapter 3). Never in a chase. *He bends a mind with a look.*

**Gift: Shape of the Night** PICK ONE · 1 CHARGE A USE

- **Bat** (default): Roll Nimble instead of the trait the obstacle calls for (in a chase, instead of the ground's). *He flits up to the window.*
- **Mist**: Roll the Monster die without risking Suspicion: if it shows, Suspicion doesn't rise for it (Trouble or a Cost still counts). *If he shows, it's only fog.*

- **Wolf**: Your trait die is one size bigger for this roll (a d8 becomes a d10). *The strength and speed of a wolf.*

**Perk** PICK ONE · ALWAYS ON

- **Hypnotic Eyes** (default): On Charm rolls, the Monster shows only if it beats your trait die by 2 or more.
- **Old Money**: A Cost on a Charm roll is never Suspicion +1.
- **Wall-Crawler**: In a chase you can always roll Nimble, whatever the ground.

**Castle Duty** (default): Butler, who shops for silver, china and linen.

**Weakness: Garlic**. Always: from the first round of any chase, your trait die is one size smaller. *Every kitchen in town has some, and the mob knows it.*

**Tell: No Reflection**. *A shop window shows everyone but him.*



## Frankenstein's Creature



IN COSTUME



REVEALED

Brawn **d12** · Nimble **d8** · Sly **d6** · Charm **d4** · Wits **d10**

**Signature: Brute Force** 1 CHARGE

Roll Brawn instead of the trait the obstacle calls for (in a chase, instead of the ground's). *Stronger than any man, it breaks what others pick.*

**Gift: Made, Not Born** PICK ONE · 1 CHARGE A USE

- **Mountain Stride** (default): At an obstacle that doesn't list Nimble, roll Nimble at 2 lower Difficulty. Only you get past, except at the way out and the lock-up (Chapter 3). Never in a chase. *He bounds over walls the way he crossed the glaciers.*
- **Hovel Watcher**: Roll the Monster die without risking Suspicion: if it shows, Suspicion doesn't rise for it (Trouble or a Cost still counts). *He learned to watch unseen.*
- **Book-Learned**: Your trait die is one size bigger for this roll (a d8 becomes a d10). *He taught himself from books.*

**Perk** PICK ONE · ALWAYS ON

- **Strong Back** (default): You carry a Huge piece alone.
- **Tireless**: Carrying doesn't make your Nimble smaller.
- **Built to Last**: You slip free from the lock-up on a Success or a Cost.

**Castle Duty** (default): Handyman, who shops for tools and hardware.

**Weakness: Fire**. Soon: from the third round of any chase, your trait die is one size smaller. *Someone has to light the torches.*

**Tell: Head and Shoulders**. *He stands a head above the whole crowd, and no costume hides it.*

## The Mummy



IN COSTUME



REVEALED

Brawn **d10** · Nimble **d4** · Sly **d6** · Charm **d8** · Wits **d12**

**Signature: Ancient Lore** 1 CHARGE

Roll Wits instead of the trait the obstacle calls for (in a chase, instead of the ground's). *It knew this trick three thousand years ago.*

**Gift: Secrets of the Tomb** PICK ONE · 1 CHARGE A USE

- **Royal Bearing** (default): At an obstacle that doesn't list Charm, roll Charm at 2 lower Difficulty. Only you get past, except at the way out and the lock-up (Chapter 3). Never in a chase. *They still bow to a pharaoh.*
- **Just a Costume**: Roll the Monster die without risking Suspicion: if it shows, Suspicion doesn't rise for it (Trouble or a Cost still counts). *On festival night, who'd believe a real one?*
- **Old Curse**: Your trait die is one size bigger for this roll (a d8 becomes a d10). *A muttered curse, and the lock gives.*

**Perk** PICK ONE · ALWAYS ON

- **Patience of Ages** (default): "Lose a Turn" is never your Cost.
- **Keeper of Treasures**: "Drop an item" is never your Cost.
- **Fear the Curse**: When you flee alone, the mob in your local chase is 1 easier. *Nobody wants to get too close.*

**Castle Duty** (default): Librarian, who shops for books and paper.

**Weakness: A Loose Thread**. Soon: from the third round of any chase, your trait die is one size smaller. *Once someone grabs a loose end, it all starts to unravel.*

**Tell: Dust and Spice**. *A trail of dust and a smell of old spices wherever it walks.*



## The Werewolf



IN COSTUME



REVEALED

Brawn **d10** · Nimble **d12** · Sly **d6** · Charm **d4** · Wits **d8**

**Signature: Good Dog** 1 CHARGE

Roll the Monster die without risking Suspicion: if it shows, Suspicion doesn't rise for it (Trouble or a Cost still counts).  
*If the wolf shows, the crowd sees a very large dog.*

**Gift: The Wolf Within** PICK ONE · 1 CHARGE A USE

- **Keen Nose** (default): Roll Wits instead of the trait the obstacle calls for (in a chase, instead of the ground's). *It smells the way in.*
- **Through the Hedge**: At an obstacle that doesn't list Brawn, roll Brawn at 2 lower Difficulty. Only you get past, except at the way out and the lock-up (Chapter 3). Never in a chase. *It goes straight through.*
- **Howl**: Your trait die is one size bigger for this roll (a d8 becomes a d10). *A howl that freezes the crowd for a moment.*

**Perk** PICK ONE · ALWAYS ON

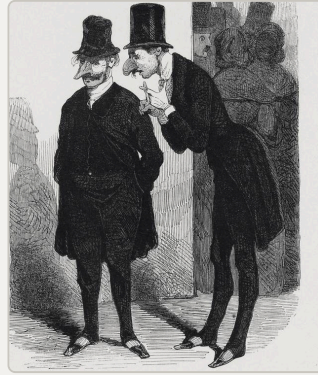
- **Night Runner** (default): When you flee alone, your local chase starts at Lead 2.
- **Shortcut**: The way out is 2 easier when you roll it.
- **Fetch**: The way out is 1 easier, whoever rolls it, while you're there, and a final flight you're in starts at Lead 3. *You know the way home.*

**Castle Duty** (default): Gardener, who shops for plants and seeds.

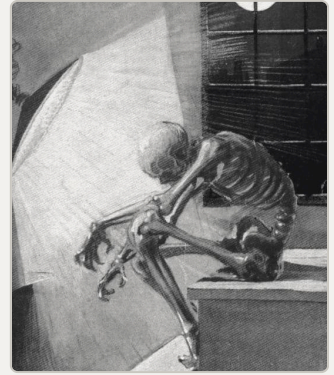
**Weakness: Hounds**. Soon: from the third round of any chase, your trait die is one size smaller. *Someone lets the hunting dogs out.*

**Tell: Eyebrows That Meet**. Brows that meet in the middle, and a little too much hair everywhere.

## The Invisible Man



IN COSTUME



REVEALED

Brawn **d4** · Nimble **d8** · Sly **d12** · Charm **d6** · Wits **d10**

**Signature: Unseen** 1 CHARGE

Roll the Monster die without risking Suspicion: if it shows, Suspicion doesn't rise for it (Trouble or a Cost still counts).  
*When the Monster shows, there's nothing to see.*

**Gift: A Scientist's Tricks** PICK ONE · 1 CHARGE A USE

- **Through the Gap** (default): At an obstacle that doesn't list Nimble, roll Nimble at 2 lower Difficulty. Only you get past, except at the way out and the lock-up (Chapter 3). Never in a chase. *He slips through as the door swings shut.*
- **Poltergeist**: Your trait die is one size bigger for this roll (a d8 becomes a d10). *Things move by themselves, and everyone looks the other way.*
- **Work It Out**: Roll Wits instead of the trait the obstacle calls for (in a chase, instead of the ground's). *A scientist's mind finds another way.*

**Perk** PICK ONE · ALWAYS ON

- **Out of Sight** (default): Trouble gets you caught only while you or anyone in the same place carries loot or furniture. *They can't see you, but they can see a floating candlestick.*
- **Hidden Pockets**: Captured, you keep the loot you carry (not furniture).
- **Light Step**: The loud way costs you no Suspicion.

**Castle Duty** (default): Tailor, who shops for cloth and costumes.

**Weakness: Flour**. Soon: from the third round of any chase, your trait die is one size smaller. *Someone throws a bag of flour, and there he is.*

**Tell: Bandages and Goggles**. A wrapped head, dark goggles, a false nose, and a sneeze from nowhere.

## A Ghost



IN COSTUME



REVEALED

Brawn **d4** · Nimble **d12** · Sly **d10** · Charm **d8** · Wits **d6**

**Signature: Through the Wall** 1 CHARGE

At an obstacle that doesn't list Sly, roll Sly at 2 lower Difficulty. Only you get past, except at the way out and the lock-up (Chapter 3). Never in a chase. Not while you carry loot or furniture: nothing you carry passes through. *It drifts in where there's no door.*

**Gift: Haunting** PICK ONE · 1 CHARGE A USE

- **Chill** (default): Your trait die is one size bigger for this roll (a d8 becomes a d10). *A sudden cold, and fingers fumble.*
- **Whisper**: Roll Charm instead of the trait the obstacle calls for (in a chase, instead of the ground's). *A voice in the ear.*
- **Fade**: Roll the Monster die without risking Suspicion: if it shows, Suspicion doesn't rise for it (Trouble or a Cost still counts). *A trick of the light.*

**Perk** PICK ONE · ALWAYS ON

- **Spectral** (default): You get past group obstacles without rolling and without using your action, even in a Turn you move; not while you carry loot or furniture.
- **Rattle**: The Monster showing on your roll is Suspicion +1, not +2. *Nobody takes rattling chains seriously.*
- **Already Dead**: Cornered in a local chase, you're back where you were caught and lose your next Turn instead of being captured (if the Limit comes that round, you just join the final flight).

**Castle Duty** (default): Butler, who shops for silver, china and linen.

**Weakness: Cold Iron.** Always: from the first round of any chase, your trait die is one size smaller. *Horseshoes, railings, a poker from the fire: every street has some.*

**Tell: Cold Spot.** Candles gutter and breath fogs wherever it drifts.

## A Witch



IN COSTUME



REVEALED

Brawn **d6** · Nimble **d4** · Sly **d10** · Charm **d8** · Wits **d12**

**Signature: Hedge Spell** 1 CHARGE

One trait die is one size bigger for one roll in the same place, yours or a friend's (in a local chase, only yours).

**Gift: Witchcraft** PICK ONE · 1 CHARGE A USE

- **Broomstick** (default): At an obstacle that doesn't list Nimble, roll Nimble at 2 lower Difficulty. Only you get past, except at the way out and the lock-up (Chapter 3). Never in a chase. *In over the rooftops, quiet as an owl.*
- **Black Cat**: Roll the Monster die without risking Suspicion: if it shows, Suspicion doesn't rise for it (Trouble or a Cost still counts). *Everyone blames the cat.*
- **A Potion for That**: Roll Wits instead of the trait the obstacle calls for (in a chase, instead of the ground's). *There's a potion for everything.*

**Perk** PICK ONE · ALWAYS ON

- **Familiar's Warning** (default): When you arrive (alone or with others), a Tell check goes off only if a second d6 also rolls 4–6. *The cat warns you.*
- **Fly by Night**: In a chase you can always roll Wits, whatever the ground.
- **Wise Woman**: A Cost on your Wits roll is never "lose a Turn".

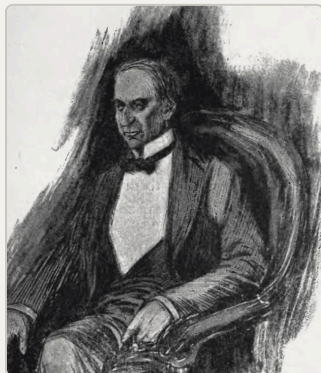
**Castle Duty** (default): Cook, who shops for food and drink.

**Weakness: Rowan.** Soon: from the third round of any chase, your trait die is one size smaller. *A sprig of rowan, the old charm against witches: somebody's grandmother always has one.*

**Tell: A Black Cat.** A black cat follows her everywhere and stares at people.



## Jekyll & Hyde



IN COSTUME



REVEALED

*Jekyll*: Brawn **d4** · Nimble **d6** · Sly **d8** · Charm **d12** · Wits **d10**

*Hyde*: Brawn **d12** · Nimble **d10** · Sly **d8** · Charm **d4** · Wits **d6**

### Signature: The Draught 1 CHARGE

Before one of your rolls, change form: Jekyll to Hyde or back (each has its own dice). The new form lasts until the next draught. Each raid starts with Jekyll. When the Monster shows on one of Jekyll's rolls, Hyde takes over at once, free.

### Gift: The Other Self PICK ONE · 1 CHARGE A USE

- **Doctor's Bag** (default): Your trait die is one size bigger for this roll (a d8 becomes a d10). *The right instrument for the job.*

- **Pillar of Society**: Roll the Monster die without risking Suspicion: if it shows, Suspicion doesn't rise for it (Trouble or a Cost still counts). *A respectable doctor having a funny turn (if the Monster shows, Hyde still takes over).*
- **Trample**: At an obstacle that doesn't list Brawn, roll Brawn at 2 lower Difficulty. Only you get past, except at the way out and the lock-up (Chapter 3). Never in a chase. A d4 as Jekyll, a d12 as Hyde.

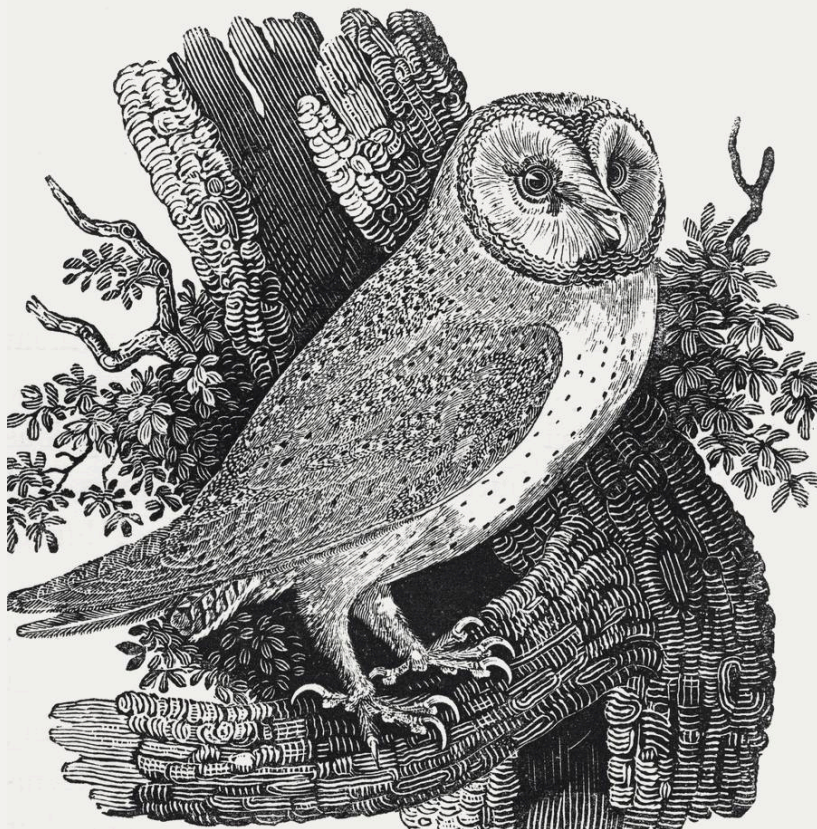
### Perk PICK ONE · ALWAYS ON

- **Practised Hand** (default): Changing back to Jekyll costs no charge.
- **Steady Nerves**: Hyde takes over only if the Monster beats your trait die by 2 or more.
- **Brute Strength**: As Hyde, carrying doesn't make your Nimble smaller.

**Castle Duty** (default): Librarian, who shops for books and paper.

**Weakness: A Familiar Face.** Soon: from the third round of any chase, your trait die is one size smaller. *Someone in the mob recognises the good doctor.*

**Tell: The Wrong Hand.** *One hand a gentleman's, the other hairy and knotted.*





## CHAPTER 3

# Rolling the Dice

**W**HEN THE OUTCOME IS IN DOUBT, YOU ROLL TWO dice — your trait die and your Mask or Monster die — and add them together.

## The Roll

1. **The obstacle sets the trait.** Each obstacle lists one or two traits that work, usually one of them the loud way (Suspicion +1 whatever the result, Chapter 5). Using any other trait needs an ability.
2. **Choose the second die:** the Mask d6 or the Monster d10.
3. **Roll both, add them,** and compare the total with the Difficulty: **6** easy, **8** standard, **10** hard, **12** daunting.

## Results

- **Success:** the total meets the Difficulty. You do it.
- **Cost:** 1–2 short. You do it, at a cost the Storyteller picks: Suspicion +1, drop an item, lose a Turn (you skip your next action), or your next roll's trait die one size smaller. A dropped item or piece stays where you are (the location, the way out or the lock-up; between places, the one you left, and you're back there too); drop yours any time but in a local chase. Anyone there may pick up any number of items, as their action for a Turn. The Storyteller never picks a Cost that costs nothing right then (say, a Suspicion +1 the roll already raised); "drop an item" drops one of your own items, never what this roll wins.
- **Trouble:** 3 or more short. It doesn't happen, Suspicion rises by 1, and if anyone is watching, you are caught (Chapter 6).
- **Critical:** a Success where both dice show the same face. In a chase it counts as two Successes; anywhere else you get back one spent charge, up to your starting number.

## The Monster Shows

If you rolled the Monster die and it came up **higher than your trait die**, the monster did the work and it showed: **Suspicion +2**. On a tie, or with the Mask, nothing shows.

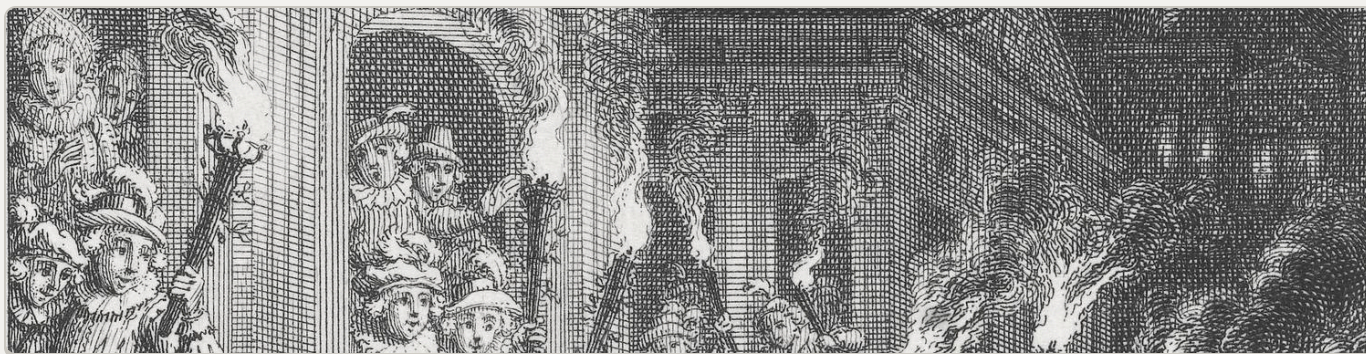
## Abilities

Using an ability costs one charge. At zero charges you can still use one, at a price: **overdraw** costs **Suspicion +2**, or your Weakness once the hunt is on (Chapter 6). Every ability does one of four things:

- **Raise your trait die one size** (a d12 can't go higher).
- **Use the ability's trait** instead of the one the obstacle calls for (in a chase, instead of the ground's).
- **Roll the Monster die without risking Suspicion:** if it shows, that raises nothing (Trouble or a Cost still counts).
- **Open an approach nobody else can take:** at any obstacle, not only a way in, if it doesn't list the ability's trait, roll that trait at 2 lower Difficulty, watched as usual. Never in a chase. Only you get through (others must beat it themselves), though the way out (everyone leaves) and a rescue work as usual, and a captive may open its own way out.

Spend abilities before you roll. An ability can help any Entity's roll at the same place (a location, the way out or the lock-up), even past obstacles you haven't crossed; helping costs the charge, not your action. The roller rolls its own die; you can only open an approach on your own roll. Several abilities may go on one roll, but it takes **at most one raise**, from any source, Castle Duty included. Raises and steps down cancel out (a d4 stepped down and raised stays a d4, and a d12 raised and stepped down stays a d12). Nothing makes a die smaller than a d4: further steps down are lost.





## CHAPTER 4

# The Raid

**T**HE RAID HAPPENS ON THE TOWN'S YEARLY FESTIVAL, **Lantern Night**, when everyone dresses up as a monster — which is why real ones can almost pass in the crowd. Dawn ends it.

## The Shopping List

Before the raid, the Storyteller rolls the shopping list (Chapter 8; Chapter 9's towns have theirs): **4 items on Easy, 5 on Standard and Hard**. One or two are **essentials**; the rest are **extras**. Each item is one of six kinds (Chapter 2).

## The Town

- **An obstacle:** one or two traits that work, and a Difficulty. It is **watched** or not.
- **A location:** 1–3 obstacles, crossed in order, guarding a list item (or two sharing a place); beat or pass the last and the loot is in your hand. Its two ways in are two versions of the first obstacle (say, front door or back window): the party picks one and keeps to it. It's watched if any obstacle is, either way in.
- **The way out** of town, always watched.

## Turns

The night lasts **12 Turns**. The party starts at the edge of town, by the way out, and gets in without a roll. Each Turn, every Entity takes one action: a roll at its location, a move, picking up, or waiting (any move takes one Turn unless the map says otherwise). Entities act one at a time, in any order, and each result (a move too) counts at once. Several may try the same obstacle in one Turn; each try risks Trouble. The party may split up, and on Standard and Hard it usually should: there's rarely time to visit every place together. **Dawn** comes when the 12th Turn ends: anyone still in town runs for it in the final flight (Chapter 6).

Once anyone beats an obstacle (a Success or a Cost), it stays beaten for the whole party, unless it's marked **group** (a crowd, a guard who checks everyone): then each Entity who wants past rolls for itself. When several roll it in the same Turn (a **group check**), all declare their dice and abilities, then roll together; Suspicion rises only once, by the biggest trigger among their rolls.

## Furniture

One piece of furniture or decor (Chapter 8) stands at one of the list's locations, behind one extra obstacle, 2 harder (at most 12). Once that location's loot has been taken, whoever is past all its obstacles may try for the piece. Bringing it home turns a Win into a **Grand Year** (Chapter 7).

## Carrying

- **Bulky** pieces need one carrier, **Huge** two (not through an entrance a map marks small). Carriers can't use the Mask; their Nimble is one size smaller.
- Carrying, a move takes two Turns: you're between places until you act in the second.
- Taking a piece is free (taking it back up is an action); drop it any time but in a local chase. Once taken, it raises Suspicion by 1 at the end of each Turn, even set down, until it's carried out of town, lost or abandoned (free: it stays put, goes quiet, can't be taken again).
- Loot has no limit; hand it over free in the same place.

## Getting Out

The way out is one watched obstacle: **Sly or Nimble, or Brawn the loud way**. The party leaves together: everyone not captured is there, and one rolls for all. A Success or a Cost gets everyone out, free. On Trouble, Suspicion rises and the roller is caught (Chapter 6); try again next Turn.



## CHAPTER 5

# Suspicion

**T**HE WHOLE TOWN SHARES ONE **SUSPICION** TRACK, from 0 up to a **Limit**: 11 on Easy and Standard, 15 on Hard.

## What Raises It

| TRIGGER                                    | SUSPICION |
|--------------------------------------------|-----------|
| Trouble                                    | +1        |
| The Monster shows                          | +2        |
| Taking the loud way                        | +1        |
| A Cost chosen as Suspicion                 | +1        |
| Overdraw                                   | +2        |
| A Tell goes off                            | +1        |
| Furniture taken, each Turn (even set down) | +1        |

### THE LOUD WAY

When an obstacle lists a loud way and you take it, Suspicion rises by 1, whatever the result. A trait the obstacle lists as loud is loud however you came to roll it.

### ONE ROLL, ONE RISE

One roll raises Suspicion only once, by its biggest trigger (overdraw included). Good results never lower it.

## Tells

The first time anyone reaches each watched location (a watched furniture obstacle doesn't count; the lock-up does, and the way out when anyone first comes back to it; not a captive being brought in), check once, however the party has split: roll a d6, and on **4–6** a Tell goes off. Roll to see whose, among the Entities arriving (all who move there in the same Turn): its Tell shows (Chapter 2), and Suspicion rises by 1.

## Getting Caught

Trouble at a watched obstacle (it's the obstacle you roll that counts) gets the Entity caught, and a **local chase** starts (Chapter 6). Everyone who gets Trouble in one group check is caught together and flees together. Trouble where nobody is watching still raises Suspicion, but starts no chase.

## At the Limit

When Suspicion reaches the Limit — or dawn comes with anyone still in town — the whole town hunts. Every Entity who isn't captured flees together in the **final flight** (Chapter 6). If the Limit comes during a local chase, that chase ends at once (even if a runner pushed it there on purpose) and those Entities join the flight; anyone the same round cornered is captured first and stays behind. From then on Suspicion stops. The track never goes past the Limit; extra points are lost.





## CHAPTER 6

# Chases and Getting Forked

**T**HERE ARE TWO KINDS OF CHASE. GET CAUGHT DURING the raid and you run from a crowd; botch the whole job and the entire town turns out with pitchforks.

## The Lead

Every chase uses a **Lead** track. Each round you roll against the mob's Difficulty:

- **Success:** Lead +1 (a Critical: +2).
- **Cost:** no change.
- **Trouble:** Lead -1.

Reach the escape number and you are clear. Reach 0 and you are cornered. In a chase the roll moves the Lead: a Cost costs nothing more, and Trouble doesn't start another chase. In a local chase, Trouble and the Monster showing still raise Suspicion (one roll, one rise); when several flee together, it rises once a round, by the biggest trigger.

## The Ground

Each round, roll a d6 on the chase table at the end of this chapter. The result says which traits work this round for everyone in the chase, and always includes one that isn't Nimble.

## Your Weakness

Once the mob brings your Weakness, you roll your trait one size smaller for the rest of the chase. Each Weakness (Chapter 2) says when the mob brings it:

- **Always:** from the first round of any chase (Dracula, a Ghost).
- **Soon:** from the third round of any chase (everyone else).
- The final flight is a new chase, even for those who join it from a local one.

## The Local Chase

When you are caught during the raid, you run, and you can't drop or hand over anything until the chase ends. Your Lead starts at **1** and you escape at **4**. The mob's Difficulty is **8 plus half the Suspicion** (round down), at most 12, checked each round. You may use the Mask. In a local chase, abilities help only your own roll. The chase happens within the Turn it started; escape and you're back where you were caught, with your Turn used up. Entities caught together in one group check flee together on one shared Lead, which moves by the majority rule below, and are captured together if cornered.

## Captured

Cornered in a local chase, you are **captured**, and the town takes back what you were carrying, furniture included: it's gone for the night, and nobody can take it again. You are held at the town's **lock-up** (you can't pick up or be handed anything, but you can still spend charges, on your own roll or a rescuer's).

- **Rescue:** the lock-up is an obstacle — Sly, or Brawn the loud way, always watched — at the lock-up Difficulty (10), with a new rescue obstacle for each capture. Getting there is a move. Beat it (a Success or a Cost) and every captive there is free, at the lock-up, and acts again next Turn; a rescuer's Trouble gets them caught as usual.
- **Slipping free:** once per Turn, from the Turn after its capture, a captive may try to slip free: Sly or Nimble, or Brawn the loud way, at the lock-up Difficulty (it's always watched). Only a Success frees you; a Cost does nothing, and on Trouble Suspicion rises but no chase starts. A freed Entity starts at the lock-up and acts again next Turn.

- **Left behind:** anyone still held when the party leaves town is left behind (Chapter 7).

## The Final Flight

At the Limit, or at dawn, every Entity who isn't captured flees together; anything dropped in the flight is left in town. The Lead starts at **2** and the party escapes at **5** (at **6** on Hard). The mob's Difficulty is set by the town's difficulty (10 on Easy, 11 on Standard and Hard) and doesn't change with the size of the party. Everyone flees together, so abilities can help anyone's roll.

### THE MAJORITY RULE

Everyone rolls each round, in any order the party likes. If Successes outnumber Trouble, the Lead rises by 1, or by 2 if they outnumber it by two or more; if Trouble outnumbers Successes, it falls the same way; otherwise it stays. A Critical counts as two Successes.

**Escape** and you are home with the goods. Get cornered and the party is **forked**: the monsters in the flight are killed (a captive is left behind) and the raid is lost.

## Once the Hunt Is On

From the moment the final flight begins, Suspicion stops and **the Mask is off**: everyone rolls the Monster die. You may still overdraw, once per flight, but your Weakness is then in play from your own next roll (even later the same round) to the end of the flight, and while your Weakness is in play, however it came, you can't overdraw.

## The Chase Table

| D6 | THE GROUND                                                                        | TRAITS THAT WORK |
|----|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|
| 1  | <b>The crowded square.</b> Lose yourself in the crowd, or bluff your way through. | Sly, Charm       |
| 2  | <b>Back alleys.</b> Duck, dodge, double back.                                     | Nimble, Sly      |
| 3  | <b>The market stalls.</b> Overturn a cart, vault a stall.                         | Brawn, Nimble    |
| 4  | <b>Over the rooftops.</b> Climb, jump, find a way down.                           | Nimble, Wits     |
| 5  | <b>The festival parade.</b> Join in: you're in costume, after all.                | Charm, Sly       |
| 6  | <b>A dead end.</b> Break through, or think fast.                                  | Brawn, Wits      |







## CHAPTER 7

# How the Year Went

**W**HEN THE PARTY IS OUT OF TOWN — OR THE MOB has the last word — look at what came home.

| RESULT     | WHEN                                                                                          |
|------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Grand Year | A Win, plus at least one piece of furniture or decor                                          |
| Win        | Every essential, and at most one extra missing                                                |
| Partial    | Less than a Win, with at least half the list home (missing an essential is at best a Partial) |
| Bust       | Less than half the list home                                                                  |
| Forked     | Cornered in the final flight: the raid ends                                                   |

## Left Behind

Each Entity left behind in the lock-up drops the result one step: a Grand Year becomes a Win, a Win a Partial, a Partial a Bust. Bust is as low as it goes, short of being forked.

## The Epilogue

The result decides the epilogue — how the castle's year goes — and nothing else. Nothing carries over to the next raid, unless you play the optional campaign rules below. Read the line for the result, then (except after Forked) one line for each kind with an item on the list that didn't come home.

| RESULT     | THE YEAR                                                                                           |
|------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Grand Year | A year of plenty. The new piece goes in the great hall, and everyone pretends it was always there. |
| Win        | Full larders, warm fires. The castle creaks happily through another year.                          |
| Partial    | The castle gets by, just. Someone has to sleep in the draughty tower.                              |
| Bust       | A long, thin year, and a lot of arguing about whose fault it was.                                  |
| Forked     | The town tells the story for years. Next Lantern Night, the bells ring a little louder.            |

| MISSING                 | WHAT THE CASTLE WENT WITHOUT                                  |
|-------------------------|---------------------------------------------------------------|
| Food and drink          | Turnip soup every night until spring.                         |
| Plants and seeds        | Nothing grows but nettles, and the nettles win.               |
| Books and paper         | Nobody knows what the town is saying, or what day it is.      |
| Silver, china and linen | Dinner is served on old coffin lids.                          |
| Tools and hardware      | Every door in the castle creaks, sticks or falls off.         |
| Cloth and costumes      | Next year's disguises are held together with string and hope. |

### OPTIONAL: CAMPAIGN PLAY

For groups who play several raids: each piece of furniture or decor brought home becomes a **castle upgrade**. In every later raid, each upgrade gives one Entity of the players' choice **one extra charge** (part of its starting number that raid). The castle holds **three upgrades** at most; bringing home a fourth replaces one of them. Nothing negative carries over, and the Entities themselves don't change.

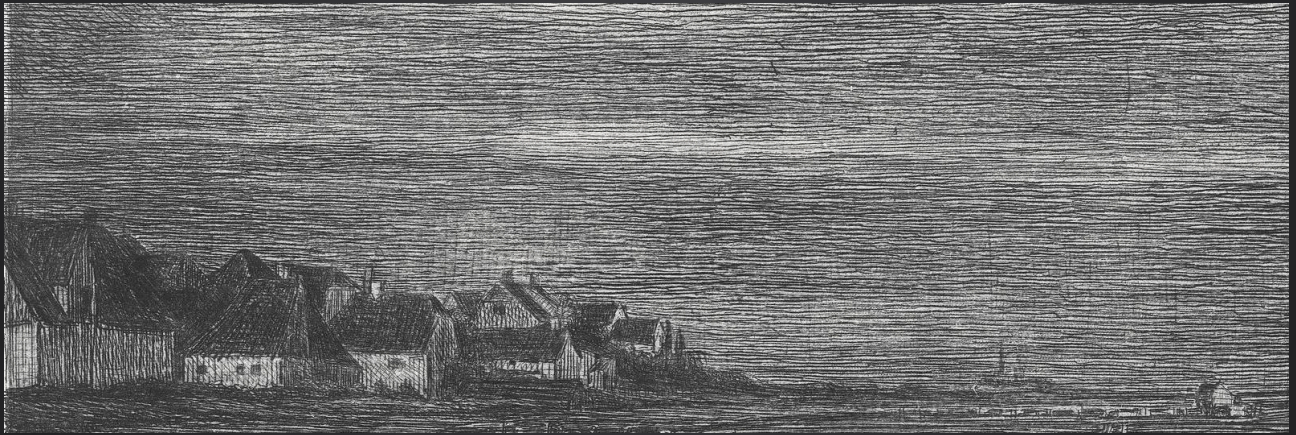




PART TWO

# Running the Game

*For the Storyteller: building a town, setting its difficulty,  
and running the villagers and the mob.*





## CHAPTER 8

# Building a Town

**E**VERY RAID IS ON A NEW TOWN. THERE ARE THREE ways to build one, all from the same parts — obstacles, locations, and the way out.

### Three Ways

- **A premade raid:** a fixed set of locations and obstacles, ready to run. Chapter 9 has three, one for each difficulty, each with its map.
- **A map:** a set of locations the party picks its route through.
- **The random tables:** roll the locations, obstacles, loot and villagers. A ceiling on the hardest obstacles keeps a rolled town playing at the difficulty it promises.

### Lantern Night

On the festival night, everyone dresses up as a monster and carries a lantern to keep the real ones away. Every town keeps it its own way: roll a d6 or pick a custom for each town. Customs are flavour, not rules.

#### D6 LOCAL CUSTOM

- |   |                                                                        |
|---|------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1 | Turnip lanterns in every window.                                       |
| 2 | A costume parade through the square at midnight.                       |
| 3 | A masked ball at the mayor's house.                                    |
| 4 | Pies left on doorsteps "for the wanderers".                            |
| 5 | A bonfire in the square, and a straw monster burned at dawn.           |
| 6 | Bells rung every hour to keep the real monsters away. They never work. |

### Rolling a Town

1. **Locations:** one for each item on the list, at one of the places its kind is found (the shopping table below lists them): a d3 or pick, one item per place; if a kind has more items than places, two may share a place (one location, guarding both).
2. **Obstacles:** roll a d20 for how many each location has.
3. **Each obstacle** (both versions of the first, its two ways in, and the furniture's extra one, 2 harder): the obstacle table for what it is, a d20 for its Difficulty, a d10 for whether it's watched. For the second way in, roll the obstacle table again until its quiet way is a different trait.
4. **The ceiling:** at most one Difficulty 12 in an Easy or Standard town, two in a Hard town (the furniture's obstacle counts by its roll, before its +2). Reroll any extra.

| ROLL                          | EASY                                  | STANDARD                              | HARD                                |
|-------------------------------|---------------------------------------|---------------------------------------|-------------------------------------|
| Obstacles at a location (d20) | 1–10: one · 11–18: two · 19–20: three | 1–6: one · 7–15: two · 16–20: three   | 1–4: one · 5–13: two · 14–20: three |
| Difficulty (d20)              | 1–3: 6 · 4–13: 8 · 14–19: 10 · 20: 12 | 1–3: 6 · 4–13: 8 · 14–19: 10 · 20: 12 | 1–8: 8 · 9–17: 10 · 18–20: 12       |
| Watched (d10)                 | 1–4                                   | 1–5                                   | 1–6                                 |



## The Obstacle Table

The quiet way gets past without a fuss; the loud way works too, but Suspicion rises by 1 whatever the result (Chapter 5). At a *group* obstacle, everyone there rolls for themselves (Chapter 4).

| D20 | OBSTACLE                                                     | QUIET WAY                      | LOUD WAY                                              |
|-----|--------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|
| 1   | A heavy cellar trapdoor                                      | Brawn                          | —                                                     |
| 2   | A tug-of-war across the lane ( <i>group</i> )                | Brawn                          | —                                                     |
| 3   | A cart blocking the alley                                    | Brawn                          | Nimble (scramble over the load)                       |
| 4   | A bolted back gate                                           | Brawn (lift it off its hinges) | Charm (shout “Delivery!” until someone opens it)      |
| 5   | A high garden wall                                           | Nimble                         | Brawn (through the gate, lock and all)                |
| 6   | A shuttered window                                           | Nimble                         | Brawn (force the shutters)                            |
| 7   | The rooftops ( <i>group</i> )                                | Nimble                         | —                                                     |
| 8   | A rickety drainpipe                                          | Nimble                         | —                                                     |
| 9   | A locked front door                                          | Sly (pick the lock)            | Brawn (kick it in)                                    |
| 10  | A nosy neighbour at her window                               | Sly                            | Wits (a false alarm: “Your cat’s on the roof!”)       |
| 11  | A crowded shop floor ( <i>group</i> )                        | Sly                            | —                                                     |
| 12  | A muddy yard full of geese                                   | Sly                            | Nimble (run for it, honking)                          |
| 13  | The shopkeeper behind the counter                            | Charm                          | Sly (snatch it from under her nose)                   |
| 14  | A guard dog                                                  | Charm (good dog)               | Nimble (outrun it, barking)                           |
| 15  | A doorman checking invitations                               | Charm                          | Wits (a forged invitation that fools nobody for long) |
| 16  | Children in costumes who want a closer look ( <i>group</i> ) | Charm                          | —                                                     |
| 17  | A locked strongbox                                           | Wits (work out the catch)      | Charm (sweet-talk the clerk into opening it)          |
| 18  | A dark, cluttered back room                                  | Wits                           | Sly (rummage through everything)                      |
| 19  | The night watchman on his round                              | Wits (time his round)          | —                                                     |
| 20  | A maze of festival stalls ( <i>group</i> )                   | Wits                           | —                                                     |

## Difficulty

Choose Easy, Standard or Hard. The difficulty sets these numbers:

|                                                 | EASY              | STANDARD          | HARD              |
|-------------------------------------------------|-------------------|-------------------|-------------------|
| Shopping list (essentials)                      | 4 (1)             | 5 (1–2)           | 5 (2)             |
| Obstacle Difficulties: share of 6 · 8 · 10 · 12 | 15 · 50 · 30 · 5% | 15 · 50 · 30 · 5% | 0 · 40 · 45 · 15% |
| Suspicion Limit                                 | 11                | 11                | 15                |
| The final flight: escape at Lead                | 5                 | 5                 | 6                 |
| The way out: Difficulty                         | 6                 | 8                 | 10                |
| The final flight: mob Difficulty                | 10                | 11                | 11                |
| The lock-up: Difficulty                         | 10                | 10                | 10                |

On every difficulty: 3 charges per Entity, 12 Turns, overdraw +2 Suspicion; a local chase starts at Lead 1 and escapes at 4 against a mob of 8 plus half the Suspicion (at most 12); the final flight starts at Lead 2. In a rolled town no entrance is small.

## The Shopping List

For each item, roll a d6 for its kind and a d6 for the item itself; roll again on a repeated item. The first items rolled are the essentials (how many: the difficulty table above; on Standard, roll any die: odd, one; even, two). Only the kind matters to the rules: it decides which Castle Duty gets its edge there.

| D6 | KIND                                                                                  | THE ITEM (SECOND D6)                                                                                                                                                                           |
|----|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| 1  | <b>Food and drink</b><br><i>the baker, the butcher, the tavern cellar</i>             | 1 a wheel of strong cheese · 2 a side of bacon · 3 a cask of red wine ("for the guests") · 4 a sack of flour · 5 a jar of honey · 6 the wedding cake in the shop window                        |
| 2  | <b>Plants and seeds</b><br><i>the market garden, the florist, the seed merchant</i>   | 1 seed potatoes · 2 a pot of nightshade (purely ornamental) · 3 rose bushes for the graveyard · 4 turnip seed for next year's lanterns · 5 a crate of lilies · 6 mushroom spawn for the cellar |
| 3  | <b>Books and paper</b><br><i>the bookseller, the printer, the schoolhouse</i>         | 1 this week's newspapers · 2 black-edged writing paper · 3 a cookbook "for the guests" · 4 ink and sealing wax · 5 an almanac with next year's moons · 6 a book of etiquette                   |
| 4  | <b>Silver, china and linen</b><br><i>the silversmith, the china shop, the laundry</i> | 1 the silver spoons · 2 a tea service · 3 bed linen · 4 a lace tablecloth · 5 a pair of candlesticks · 6 a gravy boat                                                                          |
| 5  | <b>Tools and hardware</b><br><i>the smithy, the ironmonger, the carpenter</i>         | 1 a box of nails · 2 a new lock for the dungeon · 3 hinges that creak properly · 4 a lamp and a can of oil · 5 a coil of rope · 6 a length of good chain                                       |
| 6  | <b>Cloth and costumes</b><br><i>the draper, the tailor, the hatter</i>                | 1 a bolt of black velvet · 2 bandages, lots · 3 a top hat · 4 a new cape · 5 knitting wool · 6 boots in a very large size                                                                      |

### OBSTACLES

Give each obstacle one or two traits that work. When there are two, usually one is the loud way. Mark which obstacles are watched — Trouble there gets an Entity caught — and which are group obstacles that each Entity must roll for itself. Give each location two versions of its first obstacle, with different traits: its two ways in.

## The Furniture

Roll a d6 for the piece of furniture or decor standing at one of the list's locations (pick, or number them and roll a d6, rerolling a number without one; Chapter 4).

| D6 | THE PIECE           | SIZE  |
|----|---------------------|-------|
| 1  | A wingback armchair | Bulky |
| 2  | A gilt mirror       | Bulky |
| 3  | A suit of armour    | Bulky |
| 4  | A stuffed bear      | Bulky |
| 5  | A grandfather clock | Huge  |
| 6  | A four-poster bed   | Huge  |

## The Villagers

Whenever a watched obstacle needs a face, or a Cost needs someone to cause it, roll who it is and what they're doing.

| D6 | WHO                                         | WHAT THEY'RE DOING                                  |
|----|---------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| 1  | The baker's wife                            | Looking for a lost cat                              |
| 2  | The night watchman                          | Tipsy from the cider                                |
| 3  | A gang of children                          | Judging the costume contest                         |
| 4  | The vicar                                   | Carrying a lantern and a pitchfork "for the parade" |
| 5  | The mayor, in his best costume              | Gossiping, loudly                                   |
| 6  | Old Granny Mott, who has seen it all before | Practising the bells                                |

## Running the Villagers and the Mob

**Villagers and witnesses.** Everyone in town is in costume and in a good mood, and they see what they expect to see. A watched obstacle means someone is looking; if it isn't already a person, give them a face (one of a ready-made town's villagers, or a roll). Play the town busy and cheerful, until it isn't.



**Choosing Costs.** Pick the one that hurts most right now, but never one that costs nothing (Chapter 3). A lost Turn bites near dawn, a smaller die before a hard roll, “drop an item” when someone carries loot, Suspicion +1 near the Limit. A Cost at the way out costs nothing: everyone still leaves. Always say what happened: the baker’s wife looks twice.

**Suspicion.** Keep the track where everyone can see it, and let the town’s mood follow it: whispers, then pointing, then torches.

**The mob.** Once the hunt is on, the mob is like the weather: always there, always closer. Read the ground off the chase table every round. When a Weakness comes into play

(Chapter 6), make it a moment.

**The lock-up.** Capture is a setback, not an ending. The captive can try to slip free every Turn, and the others can come for them (Chapter 6). Keep the captive’s player, and anyone else waiting, busy: let them voice a jailer or a villager.

**Pacing.** Count the Turns aloud, and warn when three are left. Early on, give each player a job that suits their monster, and a new player a Difficulty 8 first. A Bulky piece by the way out still costs at least 2 Suspicion to get home (a carried move takes two Turns). A raid should fit in an hour or two; roll a town before the session (it takes about half an hour).





CHAPTER 9

# Three Towns

**T** HREE TOWNS READY TO RAID, ONE FOR EACH difficulty, each with its list, locations, obstacles, furniture, Lantern Night custom, villagers (its faces), numbers and map.

A location's first two rows are its two ways in: the party picks one and keeps to it. The furniture's obstacle is already 2 harder. On the map, an eye marks a watched location, a star the furniture. Any move takes one Turn.

EASY **Puddlecombe** *A sleepy village that has never had a real monster.*

**Lantern Night:** Pies left on doorsteps “for the wanderers”.

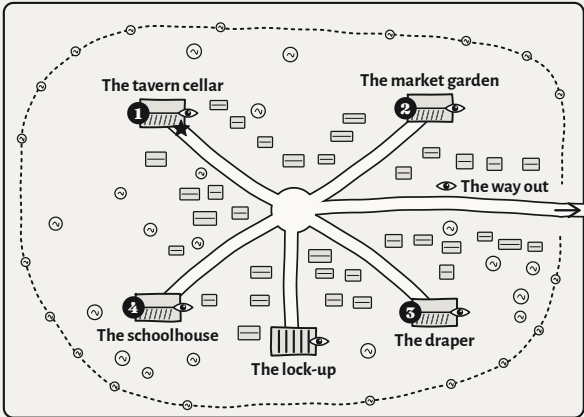
**The shopping list** (4 items):

1. **A wheel of strong cheese** (essential)
2. Seed potatoes
3. Knitting wool
4. An almanac with next year's moons

**The furniture:** a stuffed bear (Bulky), at the tavern cellar (1).

**Villagers:** the baker's wife (looking for a lost cat); the night watchman (tipsy from the cider).

**Easy:** Suspicion Limit 11 · the way out 6 · the lock-up 10 · the final flight: mob 10, escape at Lead 5.



| LOCATION · OBSTACLE                                                                      |                                                                    | QUIET WAY                      | LOUD WAY                                         | DIFFICULTY |
|------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|------------|
| <b>1 The tavern cellar: a wheel of strong cheese</b> (food and drink) · <b>essential</b> |                                                                    |                                |                                                  |            |
| WAY IN                                                                                   | A locked front door <i>watched</i>                                 | Sly (pick the lock)            | Brawn (kick it in)                               | 8          |
| OR                                                                                       | A heavy cellar trapdoor <i>watched</i>                             | Brawn                          | —                                                | 8          |
| THEN                                                                                     | A dark, cluttered back room                                        | Wits                           | Sly (rummage through everything)                 | 6          |
| FURNITURE                                                                                | A guard dog                                                        | Charm (good dog)               | Nimble (outrun it, barking)                      | 10         |
| <b>2 The market garden: seed potatoes</b> (plants and seeds)                             |                                                                    |                                |                                                  |            |
| WAY IN                                                                                   | A high garden wall                                                 | Nimble                         | Brawn (through the gate, lock and all)           | 8          |
| OR                                                                                       | A muddy yard full of geese                                         | Sly                            | Nimble (run for it, honking)                     | 6          |
| THEN                                                                                     | The night watchman on his round <i>watched</i>                     | Wits (time his round)          | —                                                | 8          |
| <b>3 The draper: knitting wool</b> (cloth and costumes)                                  |                                                                    |                                |                                                  |            |
| WAY IN                                                                                   | The shopkeeper behind the counter <i>watched</i>                   | Charm                          | Sly (snatch it from under her nose)              | 8          |
| OR                                                                                       | A shuttered window                                                 | Nimble                         | Brawn (force the shutters)                       | 10         |
| <b>4 The schoolhouse: an almanac with next year's moons</b> (books and paper)            |                                                                    |                                |                                                  |            |
| WAY IN                                                                                   | A bolted back gate                                                 | Brawn (lift it off its hinges) | Charm (shout “Delivery!” until someone opens it) | 8          |
| OR                                                                                       | A rickety drainpipe                                                | Nimble                         | —                                                | 10         |
| THEN                                                                                     | Children in costumes who want a closer look (group) <i>watched</i> | Charm                          | —                                                | 8          |



## STANDARD **Thistlewick** *A market town proud of its festival.*

**Lantern Night:** A costume parade through the square at midnight.

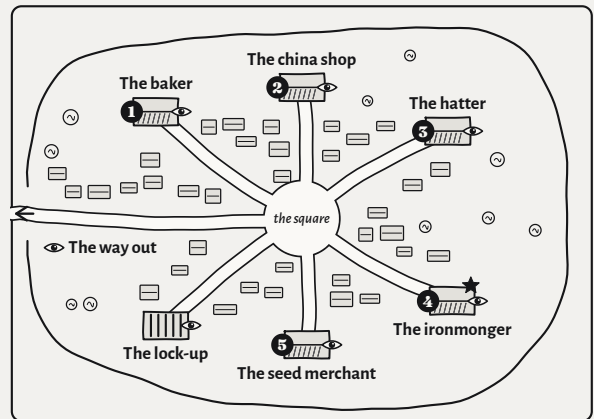
**The shopping list** (5 items):

1. **The wedding cake in the shop window** (essential)
2. **A tea service** (essential)
3. A top hat
4. A coil of rope
5. Turnip seed for next year's lanterns

**The furniture:** a gilt mirror (Bulky), at the ironmonger (4).

**Villagers:** the mayor, in his best costume (judging the costume contest); the vicar (carrying a lantern and a pitchfork "for the parade").

**Standard:** Suspicion Limit 11 · the way out 8 · the lock-up 10 · the final flight: mob 11, escape at Lead 5.



| LOCATION · OBSTACLE                                                                         | QUIET WAY                      | LOUD WAY                                         | DIFFICULTY |
|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|------------|
| <b>1 The baker: the wedding cake in the shop window</b> (food and drink) · <b>essential</b> |                                |                                                  |            |
| WAY IN A crowded shop floor (group) <i>watched</i>                                          | Sly                            | —                                                | 8          |
| OR A shuttered window                                                                       | Nimble                         | Brawn (force the shutters)                       | 8          |
| THEN The shopkeeper behind the counter <i>watched</i>                                       | Charm                          | Sly (snatch it from under her nose)              | 8          |
| <b>2 The china shop: a tea service</b> (silver, china and linen) · <b>essential</b>         |                                |                                                  |            |
| WAY IN A locked front door                                                                  | Sly (pick the lock)            | Brawn (kick it in)                               | 8          |
| OR A bolted back gate <i>watched</i>                                                        | Brawn (lift it off its hinges) | Charm (shout "Delivery!" until someone opens it) | 10         |
| THEN A dark, cluttered back room                                                            | Wits                           | Sly (rummage through everything)                 | 8          |
| <b>3 The hatter: a top hat</b> (cloth and costumes)                                         |                                |                                                  |            |
| WAY IN A nosy neighbour at her window <i>watched</i>                                        | Sly                            | Wits (a false alarm: "Your cat's on the roof!")  | 8          |
| OR The rooftops (group)                                                                     | Nimble                         | —                                                | 10         |
| <b>4 The ironmonger: a coil of rope</b> (tools and hardware)                                |                                |                                                  |            |
| WAY IN A cart blocking the alley                                                            | Brawn                          | Nimble (scramble over the load)                  | 6          |
| OR A high garden wall                                                                       | Nimble                         | Brawn (through the gate, lock and all)           | 8          |
| THEN A locked strongbox <i>watched</i>                                                      | Wits (work out the catch)      | Charm (sweet-talk the clerk into opening it)     | 8          |
| FURNITURE A guard dog <i>watched</i>                                                        | Charm (good dog)               | Nimble (outrun it, barking)                      | 10         |
| <b>5 The seed merchant: turnip seed for next year's lanterns</b> (plants and seeds)         |                                |                                                  |            |
| WAY IN A maze of festival stalls (group)                                                    | Wits                           | —                                                | 8          |
| OR A muddy yard full of geese                                                               | Sly                            | Nimble (run for it, honking)                     | 6          |
| THEN The night watchman on his round <i>watched</i>                                         | Wits (time his round)          | —                                                | 10         |

## An Example of Play

Four players raid Thistlewick: Dracula, the Witch, Frankenstein's Creature and the Werewolf, with their default picks (Butler, Cook, Handyman and Gardener). Suspicion starts at 0; the Limit is 11.

**Turn 1.** The party splits. The Witch and the Werewolf head for the baker, where the Witch's Cook Duty gives her an edge; Dracula and the Creature take the china shop, Dracula's as Butler. Both are watched, so the Storyteller makes a **Tell check** at each: a 2 and a 1, no Tells.

**Turn 2.** At the baker, the party takes the shuttered window. The Werewolf rolls Nimble d12 with the **Mask**: 10 + 4 = 14 against 8, a Success. The window is open for both of them

now, so the Witch goes on to the shopkeeper (Charm, 8, watched). Her Charm d8 is a d10 here (her Duty's raise), and she lets the **Monster** out for the bigger die: 1 + 4 = 5. That is 3 short, **Trouble**, and the Monster's 4 beat her trait die's 1, so it showed. One roll, one rise: Suspicion goes up by the bigger trigger, to 2. The shopkeeper was watching, so the Witch is caught.

She runs. Her **Lead** starts at 1, and the mob is 8 + half the Suspicion: 9. Round 1, a dead end: Wits d12 and the Monster, 12 + 3 = 15, Lead 2. Round 2, another dead end: 2 + 9 = 11, Lead 3, but the Monster showed: Suspicion 4, and the mob is now 10. Round 3, the festival parade, and out comes a sprig of rowan: her Weakness makes her Sly d10 a d8. She spends a charge on her Hedge Spell to raise it back and rolls

5 + 7 = 12: Lead 4, and she escapes. The Monster showed again: Suspicion 6. She is back at the baker, her Turn used up.

At the china shop, Dracula picks the lock of the front door with the Mask: Sly d6, a d8 with his Butler Duty, 7 + 2 = 9 against 8. The Creature takes the back room with Wits d10 and the Mask: 5 + 2 = 7, one short, a **Cost**. He has the tea service; the Storyteller picks the Cost. Dropping an item would cost nothing (he carries only what this roll won), so it's Suspicion +1: a teacup smashes. Suspicion 7.

**Turn 3.** The Witch tries the shopkeeper again, and the Werewolf spends a charge on Good Dog for her: she rolls the Monster without risking Suspicion. 7 + 4 = 11, a Success, and the wedding cake is hers. Dracula and the Creature move on to the ironmonger, which is watched: the Tell check is a 4, and a second roll picks the Creature, who stands a head above the crowd. Suspicion 8.

Three Turns gone, nine to go. Both essentials are in hand, but Suspicion is 8 of 11: from here on, every Monster counts.

## HARD Gallowsmere *A walled town that remembers last year.*

**Lantern Night:** Bells rung every hour to keep the real monsters away. They never work.

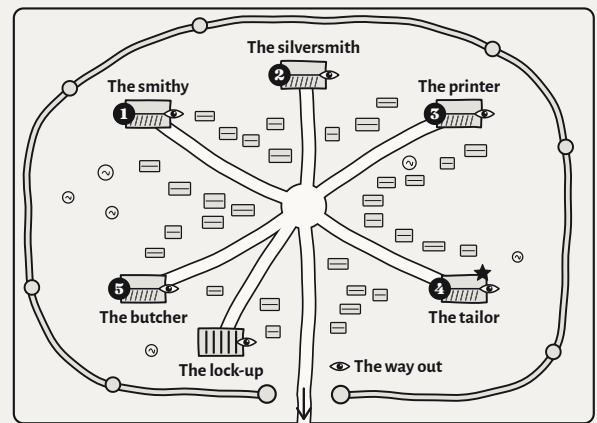
**The shopping list** (5 items):

1. **A new lock for the dungeon** (essential)
2. **The silver spoons** (essential)
3. Black-edged writing paper
4. Bandages, lots
5. A side of bacon

**The furniture:** a suit of armour (Bulky), at the tailor (4).

**Villagers:** old Granny Mott, who has seen it all before (practising the bells); a gang of children (gossiping, loudly).

**Hard:** Suspicion Limit 15 · the way out 10 · the lock-up 10 · the final flight: mob 11, escape at Lead 6.



| LOCATION · OBSTACLE                                                        |                                                  | QUIET WAY                      | LOUD WAY                                              | DIFFICULTY |
|----------------------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------|------------|
| 1 The smithy: a new lock for the dungeon (tools and hardware) · essential  |                                                  |                                |                                                       |            |
| WAY IN                                                                     | A bolted back gate <i>watched</i>                | Brawn (lift it off its hinges) | Charm (shout “Delivery!” until someone opens it)      | 10         |
| OR                                                                         | A high garden wall <i>watched</i>                | Nimble                         | Brawn (through the gate, lock and all)                | 8          |
| THEN                                                                       | The night watchman on his round <i>watched</i>   | Wits (time his round)          | —                                                     | 10         |
| 2 The silversmith: the silver spoons (silver, china and linen) · essential |                                                  |                                |                                                       |            |
| WAY IN                                                                     | A locked front door <i>watched</i>               | Sly (pick the lock)            | Brawn (kick it in)                                    | 10         |
| OR                                                                         | A shuttered window <i>watched</i>                | Nimble                         | Brawn (force the shutters)                            | 8          |
| THEN                                                                       | A guard dog <i>watched</i>                       | Charm (good dog)               | Nimble (outrun it, barking)                           | 8          |
| THEN                                                                       | A locked strongbox                               | Wits (work out the catch)      | Charm (sweet-talk the clerk into opening it)          | 10         |
| 3 The printer: black-edged writing paper (books and paper)                 |                                                  |                                |                                                       |            |
| WAY IN                                                                     | A nosy neighbour at her window <i>watched</i>    | Sly                            | Wits (a false alarm: “Your cat’s on the roof!”)       | 8          |
| OR                                                                         | The rooftops (group)                             | Nimble                         | —                                                     | 10         |
| THEN                                                                       | A dark, cluttered back room                      | Wits                           | Sly (rummage through everything)                      | 8          |
| 4 The tailor: bandages, lots (cloth and costumes)                          |                                                  |                                |                                                       |            |
| WAY IN                                                                     | A doorman checking invitations <i>watched</i>    | Charm                          | Wits (a forged invitation that fools nobody for long) | 10         |
| OR                                                                         | A rickety drainpipe                              | Nimble                         | —                                                     | 8          |
| THEN                                                                       | A crowded shop floor (group) <i>watched</i>      | Sly                            | —                                                     | 10         |
| FURNITURE                                                                  | A heavy cellar trapdoor                          | Brawn                          | —                                                     | 12         |
| 5 The butcher: a side of bacon (food and drink)                            |                                                  |                                |                                                       |            |
| WAY IN                                                                     | A muddy yard full of geese <i>watched</i>        | Sly                            | Nimble (run for it, honking)                          | 8          |
| OR                                                                         | A cart blocking the alley <i>watched</i>         | Brawn                          | Nimble (scramble over the load)                       | 10         |
| THEN                                                                       | The shopkeeper behind the counter <i>watched</i> | Charm                          | Sly (snatch it from under her nose)                   | 10         |
| THEN                                                                       | A tug-of-war across the lane (group)             | Brawn                          | —                                                     | 12         |



# Entity Sheet

Copy this page for each player. Fill it in from your Entity's entry in Chapter 2.

Player \_\_\_\_\_ Entity \_\_\_\_\_

Castle Duty \_\_\_\_\_ Shops for \_\_\_\_\_

| BRAWN | NIMBLE | SLY | CHARM | WITS |
|-------|--------|-----|-------|------|
|       |        |     |       |      |

One each of d12, d10, d8, d6 and d4. The second die: the **Mask d6** or the **Monster d10** (it shows if it rolls higher than your trait die: Suspicion +2).

**Charges** ○ ○ ○ castle upgrades: ○ ○ ○ overdraw: Suspicion +2, or your Weakness once the hunt is on (once per flight)

**Signature** \_\_\_\_\_

**Gift** \_\_\_\_\_

**Perk** \_\_\_\_\_

**Weakness** \_\_\_\_\_ ☐ Always ☐ Soon

**Tell** \_\_\_\_\_

**Form** (Jekyll & Hyde; starts as Jekyll) ☐ Jekyll ☐ Hyde

| CARRYING (LOOT) | FURNITURE | STATUS                                                                                                                                                                               |
|-----------------|-----------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
|                 |           | <input type="checkbox"/> In town<br><input type="checkbox"/> Caught<br><input type="checkbox"/> Captured<br><input type="checkbox"/> Fleeing<br><input type="checkbox"/> Out of town |

**Next** ☐ roll: trait die one size smaller (a Cost) ☐ action: lost (lose a Turn, a Cost)

**In a chase** ☐ Weakness in play ☐ overdrawn this flight

**Notes** \_\_\_\_\_

One raise per roll, from any source. Nothing makes a die smaller than a d4.

# At the Table

The rules on one page. The chapters have the details.

## THE ROLL (CHAPTER 3)

Your **trait die** + the **Mask d6** or the **Monster d10**, against the Difficulty: **6** easy, **8** standard, **10** hard, **12** daunting.

- **Success:** meet it.
- **Cost:** 1–2 short. You do it; the Storyteller picks: Suspicion +1, drop an item, lose a Turn, or your next trait die one size smaller.
- **Trouble:** 3+ short. Suspicion +1; caught if watched.
- **Critical:** a Success on doubles. A spent charge back, or two Successes in a chase.
- **The Monster shows** if it beats your trait die: Suspicion +2.

## ABILITIES (CHAPTER 3)

One charge each, spent before the roll. Raise your trait die one size; use the ability's trait; roll the Monster without risking Suspicion; or open your own approach with an unlisted trait (2 lower, your roll only, never in a chase). **One raise per roll.** At zero charges, overdraw: Suspicion +2, or your Weakness once the hunt is on (once per flight; from your own next roll).

## TURNS (CHAPTER 4)

**12 Turns**, then dawn. Each Turn, each Entity rolls, moves, picks up or waits. A beaten obstacle stays beaten, unless it's a **group** one (everyone rolls). At a location with your Duty's kind of item: trait die one size larger (the one raise). Carrying: moves take two Turns. The way out: Sly or Nimble, or Brawn the loud way; one roll for all.

## SUSPICION (CHAPTER 5)

Trouble +1 · the Monster shows +2 · the loud way +1 · a Cost chosen as Suspicion +1 · overdraw +2 · a Tell +1 (4–6 on a d6, first visit to a watched place) · furniture, each Turn once taken +1. **One roll, one rise**, by its biggest trigger. At the Limit, or at dawn, the whole town hunts.

## CHASES (CHAPTER 6)

- **Local chase:** Lead 1, escape at 4, against 8 + half the Suspicion (at most 12); the Mask allowed, abilities on your own roll only. Cornered: captured (slip free on a Success, or be rescued).
- **Final flight:** everyone free; the Mask is off. Lead 2, escape at 5 (6 on Hard). Cornered: forked.
- Each round: roll the ground (the chase table); Success +1, Trouble –1. Together, the majority rule: 1 toward the side with more, 2 if it leads by 2+.
- Your Weakness: trait one size smaller (Always: round 1; Soon: round 3).

## HOW THE YEAR WENT (CHAPTER 7)

**Grand Year:** a Win and a piece of furniture or decor. **Win:** every essential, at most one extra missing. **Partial:** at least half the list. **Bust:** less. Each Entity left behind: one step down.

|                                   | EASY   | STANDARD | HARD   |
|-----------------------------------|--------|----------|--------|
| Shopping list (essentials)        | 4 (1)  | 5 (1–2)  | 5 (2)  |
| Suspicion Limit                   | 11     | 11       | 15     |
| The way out                       | 6      | 8        | 10     |
| The final flight: mob · escape at | 10 · 5 | 11 · 5   | 11 · 6 |
| The lock-up                       | 10     | 10       | 10     |

| D6 | THE GROUND (A CHASE, EACH ROUND)                                                  | TRAITS THAT WORK |
|----|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------|------------------|
| 1  | <b>The crowded square.</b> Lose yourself in the crowd, or bluff your way through. | Sly, Charm       |
| 2  | <b>Back alleys.</b> Duck, dodge, double back.                                     | Nimble, Sly      |
| 3  | <b>The market stalls.</b> Overturn a cart, vault a stall.                         | Brawn, Nimble    |
| 4  | <b>Over the rooftops.</b> Climb, jump, find a way down.                           | Nimble, Wits     |
| 5  | <b>The festival parade.</b> Join in: you're in costume, after all.                | Charm, Sly       |
| 6  | <b>A dead end.</b> Break through, or think fast.                                  | Brawn, Wits      |



# Once a year, the monsters go shopping.

Every year, on Lantern Night, the whole town dresses up as monsters. Every year, a few real ones walk in with them.

You play Dracula, Frankenstein's Creature, the Mummy, the Werewolf, the Invisible Man, a Ghost, a Witch or Jekyll & Hyde: housemates in a crumbling castle with a shopping list to fill before dawn. Hide behind the Mask, or let the Monster out and risk the town's Suspicion. Grab what the castle needs, and maybe a nice armchair. And if it all goes wrong, run, because the mob has pitchforks.



For 3–5 players and a Storyteller · 2–3 hours · ages 12+

**DON'T GET FORKED** · VERSION 0.1